

growing way of distributing coupons. Reports from Google Insights in mid-2010 showed that Internet searches for “printable coupons” increased 67 percent over a year before, for the first time surpassing searches for “Britney Spears.”

Data released by Coupons.com in February 2010 showed an increase in printed savings of over 170 percent during 2009. They reported a staggering one billion dollars in savings printed from the Coupons.com network in 2009, and a 220 percent increase in coupon printings from 2008 to 2009. According to an Inmar study, businesses issued 367 billion coupons in 2009, and buyers redeemed 3.3 billion. Online coupon access, however, increased by 92 percent, and redemption of Internet deals leaped by 360 percent. Cereal has remained the most popular category for coupon use, followed by yogurt, snacks, and pizza. Top advancing categories included restaurants and entertainment.

Will we someday see a completely paperless couponing universe? Electronic coupons, arriving by cellphone, Twitter, email, and Facebook are bringing in the new, younger customers, those who have previously rejected the paper coupon. As of February 2010, more than forty-five million American consumers are now using online coupons, representing over 20 percent of the US population. Of those, almost one third (13.1 million) do not clip coupons from their Sunday paper. The consumer who prints digital coupons has an average household income of \$97,000, and is even more likely to have a college degree than those who use newspaper coupons.

The number of consumers using their mobile phone for coupons is increasing exponentially as well. According to a Juniper Research